Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. As a data scientist, I have built forecasting and churn models and practical experimentation tools, and I am keen to bring that applied machine learning experience to a team taking AI ideas from prototype into product use.

At Thistlebox, I developed a weekly six-week recipe demand forecast using LightGBM, with scheduled runs writing results to BigQuery for operations to use in Looker. WAPE improved from 23% to 14%, with an estimated food-waste reduction of 9%. I also built a weekly BigQuery-scored XGBoost churn model whose retention targeting was validated in a 10% holdout, with churn down 2.1 percentage points in the treated group. These projects have given me hands-on experience in feature engineering, model evaluation and recurring machine learning workflows.

I have also built a Streamlit sequential A/B testing calculator used by around 25 people in product and growth, and wrote its Dockerfile; the data platform team handles deployment to Cloud Run. In 2025, I began adding pytest unit tests to forecasting feature code, now at about 60% coverage. My current work is centred on scheduled notebook and batch-scoring workflows rather than independently deployed model APIs, and I am motivated to grow further in model serving and operating machine learning systems alongside backend engineers and product managers.

Quillstone's focus on helping merchants get support quickly, and its AI team's work across models and assistants for Customer Operations, makes this role a compelling next step for my applied modelling and product-facing work. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley